

find a solution to all their problems. On the other hand, the Raspberry Pi didn't offer much in terms of openness. The only modifiable part was the SD card slot which let you change the amount of memory you used. Unless you were looking to use the 3 headers available – a 26 pin General purpose I/O, a display serial interconnect for connecting a smartphone or a tablet display and a MIPI camera interface – which open up reams of other possibilities.

The first upgrade, to Raspberry Pi B+ wasn't a drastic change and was mostly ergonomic rearrangements. Apart from the total number of USB ports being increased to 4, availability of 512MB RAM and switching to MicroSD from SD, there weren't many significant changes. Unlike the Raspberry Pi 2.

The Pi 2 included two basic, powerful upgrades: An ARM Quad Core Cortex A7 900MHz chip replacing the single core 700MHz ARM A11 and 1GB RAM instead of 512 MB. On the Software side, it comes with the Debian derivative Raspbian which came bundled with useful software like the Epiphany browser and even a stripped down version of Minecraft optimized for the Pi. Its goal of encouraging people to program is clearly evident with preloaded software like the Wolfram Mathematica tool, Python programming tools and Scratch, an animation programming IDE for kids. On the performance side, the new specs really put the numbers in Pi 2's favour with the chip performing almost thrice as fast as its predecessor in most benchmarks.

Although, there is one catch. The 35\$ price tag might not be all inclusive. Once you have the Pi in your hands you will also need the following accessories to set up a PC:

- ♦ A 5V micro-USB adapter (most smartphone and tablet chargers work fine)
- ♦ A USB keyboard and a mouse
- ♦ A microSD card with compatible OS installed (atleast 4GB, the greater the better)
- ♦ An HDMI cable or composite audio/video cord.
- ♦ A Display
- ♦ Ethernet cable or Wi-Fi dongle
- ♦ A Case (to protect those exposed components)

With both its iterations, the Raspberry Pi has stayed true to the maker spirit and has received the warm welcome of the entire community. It functions admirably in most reasonable scenarios like a home-theatre PC or a low cost storage server. Even though it is not a fully fledged PC yet, the projects that are emerging with the Pi 2 are promising.